RNI NO. MAHENG/2013/52014

Complimentary Copy

MY POWAI

Volume No. 14 Issue No. 10 Mumbai June 2026



Dear friends

June always arrives with a certain restlessness. We wait for the rains with the same impatience every year, almost as if we have forgotten that they have never failed to arrive. And then there is another familiar June ritual — schools reopening. Fresh uniforms, new books with that unmistakable smell of untouched pages, children returning with holiday stories and parents quietly slipping back into routine mode.

Our mango journey continues this month and this one travels far beyond the fruit itself. Sherry Bhatnagar takes you across India through the fascinating world of mango pickles. Every household has its own recipe, every region its own secret, and every jar carries stories along with spice. It is one of those pieces that many women will instantly connect with because recipes often travel through generations before they travel onto paper.

Breakfast is another subject close to home. We often skip it in a rush and then wonder where our energy disappeared by noon. Our nutritionist Nisha Singh neatly explains why breakfast deserves far more respect than most of us give it. And of course, the much-awaited predictions from Richa Pathak are back to tell you what the stars may have lined up for you. Alongside that, our local news section continues to keep you updated with everything happening around us.

Happy reading. As always, your thoughts, feedback and suggestions are always welcome.

Warm regards,
Mahesh Kutty
(Editor)

Team MY POWAI

MAHESH KUTTY	EDITOR
SONIA KOHLI	CO-OWNER & MANAGING PARTNER
ELSIE GABRIEL	ASSOC. EDITOR
GEETANJALI DHULEKAR	ASSOC. EDITOR

For enquiries call 98200 28993.

Email: mypowai@yahoo.in

Mkting Off: B 2072, Oberoi Garden Estate, Chandivali, Mumbai 400 072

Printed & published by Mahesh Kutty on behalf of KSportz, **Printed at Inkcraft Printing Solutions LLP.**,J-10, Ansa Industrial Estate, Saki-Vihar Road,Sakinaka, Andheri(East), Mumbai 400072 and **Published from KSportz, D-607,Kanakia Silicon Valley, Behind Hiranandani Hospital, Powai, Mumbai 400076.**

The articles expressed in this magazine are the views of the writer. My Powai is not responsible for their expressions

If you see or experience any act of injustice in our locality please report to us: mypowai@yahoo.in

FIND AND FOLLOW 'MY POWAI' ON FACEBOOK, INSTAGRAM and X



Is your ward ready for monsoon this year?



D.P.K. Udas

There are predictions of a good monsoon this year. In fact, the monsoon has already reached Kerala ahead of schedule and is expected to arrive in Mumbai before 7th June. Light showers have already begun, giving us an early indication of what lies ahead. The big question now is: is your ward ready for the rains?



Monsoon shed being erected

We have already seen a trailer of things to come in cities such as Pune and Nashik. Roads were flooded, electricity supply was disrupted and even Metro coaches reportedly developed leakages. These incidents remind us that despite yearly preparations, monsoon challenges continue to test civic systems.

In Mumbai too, the civic body undertakes extensive pre-monsoon work every year and tenders are awarded for the same. The work generally includes trimming tree branches, conducting structural assessments of old and dilapidated buildings, cleaning drainage channels and storm-water drains, taking preventive measures at regular water-logging spots, checking open electrical connections and erecting temporary monsoon sheds.

The BMC has been seen carrying out most of these activities across the city. However, one area where it appears to be lagging is the cleaning of open drains or nalas. In Powai, the largest open drain is the Somaiya Nala, which eventually joins the Mithi River. While cleaning work is underway, the pace appears slower than expected.

Another major choke point is Saki Naka, which experiences flooding almost every monsoon. Water from the hilly areas of Powai and Chandivali eventually flows into this stretch. This also includes water from the underground storm-water drain network that was developed after the devastating floods of 26th July. Any delay in cleaning these channels can create serious bottlenecks during heavy rainfall.

As per available figures at the time of writing, BMC had completed approximately 45.6% cleaning of big nalas and 54% of small nalas. Nearly 4,41,000 metric tonnes of expected silt still remains to be removed. Municipal Commissioner Ms. Ashwini Bhide has already inspected progress at various locations, including the Mithi River stretch near BKC, Dharavi and the Nehru Science Centre area at Worli. She has instructed officials to complete nala cleaning by 31st May and also install grills over open drains.

However, considering the scale of the pending work, the target appears difficult to achieve. Nearly 40,000 dumper trips may be required to remove the remaining muck. Standing Committee members are expected to inspect these sites around 24th and 25th June, suggesting that they themselves anticipate work continuing till then. By that time, Mumbai may have already turned into "Tumbai" several times over.



Solid object thrown in Nala

At the same time, the responsibility cannot rest entirely on the civic body. Citizens too have an important role to play. People often dump household waste and large discarded items such as sofas, tables, mattresses and even scrap auto-rickshaws into nalas, blocking water flow and causing flooding. Societies and residents must ensure proper maintenance by checking electrical cables and exposed connections, monitoring waterlogging inside premises, carrying out terrace waterproofing, preventing garbage accumulation, controlling mosquito breeding and ensuring adequate earthing systems. Along with this, citizens must continue to keep pressure on civic authorities to complete the unfinished agenda before the monsoon arrives in full force.

(The author is long time resident of Powai. He takes up civic issues with the authorities. He has been instrumental in improving illumination in the area, zebra crossings , garbage removal etc.)



IMPLANTS that LOOK, FEEL & ACT like NORMAL TEETH*

• Affordable Dentistry • Finest quality Dental Care
• State-of-art facility • Friendly procedures • Personalised packages
• Surgeries performed by specialised professionals

ALIGNER CERTIFIED



Before you perform dental implants know about it

- The screw is first fixed to the jawbone. It is made of dental grade titanium.
- The abutment fits on top of the implant.
- The crown goes on the top of the abutment. It can be made of zirconia, gold alloy or ceramic.

Contact to see if you're a good candidate for implants.

Attached to **Dr. L. H. Hiranandani Hospital,** Powai & Thane and **KIMS Hospital**, Thane

Dr. GAUTAM V. KIKERI

BDS, MDS (Conservative Dentistry & Endodontics), **Diplomate ICOI (Implant Dentist),** FPFA (USA), NDB (USA)

M: 98200 68070 Email: gkikeri@yahoo.com Web: www.drgautamkikeri.com

209 SOLUS DENTAL CENTER, HIRANANDANI ESTATE, PATLIPADA, OFF G.B. ROAD, THANE (W) 400607

(By appointment only)

* Conditions apply

We ensure that you feel at ease during your treatment process

Can your home support you after retirement?



For many families, a home is far more than a financial asset. It represents years of hard work, sacrifices, family celebrations, and emotional security. It is often the most valuable possession built over a lifetime. But retirement brings a different reality for many senior citizens.

Regular income may reduce, medical expenses may increase, and maintaining the same lifestyle can slowly become difficult. Interestingly, many retirees today are "asset rich but cash flow poor" — owning valuable property, yet lacking regular monthly income. This is where a concept called Reverse Mortgage becomes relevant.

A reverse mortgage allows senior citizens above the age of 60 to receive regular income against their self-owned house while continuing to stay in the same home. Unlike a regular home loan, there are no monthly EMI payments during the borrower's lifetime.

The concept is simple yet powerful: The house you spent decades building can quietly begin supporting you financially during retirement.

Quick Understanding:
- Available for senior citizens above 60 years
- Income can be received monthly or quarterly
- Owners continue living in their own house
- Helps create financial comfort during retirement

One of the reasons reverse mortgages remain uncommon in India is emotional attachment. Most Indian families view homes as something to leave behind for the next generation. In countries like the United States, however, reverse mortgages are more widely accepted as part of retirement planning.

Yet, for some families, this option can offer dignity, independence, and peace of mind.

Retirement planning today is no longer only about investments and insurance. It is equally about understanding how existing assets can create financial comfort without disturbing one's lifestyle.

"Sometimes, retirement security is not about building new wealth. It is about understanding the value of the wealth already around us."

For more information or personalized retirement planning guidance, reach out to:

- Uma Kumaravelan
Certified Financial Planner
www.oaktree.in



Mic n Melodie: harmonizing careers and chords

In the high-octane corporate world of Mumbai, where life is often dictated by spreadsheets and back-to-back meetings, a refreshing rhythm is emerging from Powai. Meet Mic n Melodie (MnM)—a band redefining the traditional work-life balance. Comprising six millennial professionals, this ensemble proves that your job title doesn't have to be your only identity.

Mic n Melodie isn't your average garage band; it's a vibrant collective navigating the complexities of the modern economy. The lineup brings together a diverse range of expertise: an AI Tech Expert, a Social Media Entrepreneur, a Mutual Fund Guru, a Finance Expert, a Marketing Head, and an L&D Analyst.

By day, they are strategizing, coding, and managing portfolios. By evenings and on weekends, they shed the corporate jargon to transform into a cohesive musical unit. Their story serves as a powerful reminder that passion and profession can coexist, and more importantly, they can fuel one another.

The journey began two years ago when their paths crossed in a local musical group. What started as a casual interest quickly deepened into a strong bond. Over the past twenty-four months, these six individuals have shared countless milestones and family gatherings, evolving into one large extended unit.

Despite the pressures of corporate roles and busy home lives, music remained their common heartbeat. After a long week, they leave the routine behind and pick up their microphones to recharge. These weekend jam sessions became the incubator for Mic n Melodies (MnM), turning a hobby into a professional stage presence. For these performers, music isn't just an "extra" activity—it's the essential fuel that brings renewed focus to their daily work.

The months of balancing rehearsals with deadlines recently culminated in a major milestone: their debut live performance, "Dil Ki Playlist," at the Raheja Clubhouse happened on April 11 2026.

It was more than just a concert; it was a celebration of soulful melodies that resonated deeply with the audience. Standing under those lights, the transition was complete. The "professional" and the "passionate" collided as they performed a curated selection of tracks that mirrored their own journey—soulful, energetic, and authentic. The heartwarming reception and roar of applause served as the ultimate validation of their hard work.

The excitement from their debut hasn't faded, and the band is already back in the rehearsal room. Fueled by that energy, they are preparing for their next big performance scheduled for the Monsoon season on July 11. This upcoming show promises to bring even more harmony to the community, offering a melodic escape from the rain-soaked streets.

The story of Mic n Melodie is a testament for our fellow resident who has a dusty guitar in the corner or a hidden talent tucked away behind a laptop screen. It's a call to action: follow your passion alongside your career. Pursuing what you love doesn't just make life better—it often makes you better at what you do for a living.

To see behind-the-scenes glimpses and catch their latest performance videos, follow their story on Instagram and subscribe to their YouTube channel. Stay tuned—the melody has just begun!



Emerald Isle malayali get-together



For eight years at Emerald Isle, witnessing vibrant community celebrations like Ganpati, Durga Puja, and Holi always sparked a deep-seated longing for an event that honored the rich heritage of "God's own country".

The long overdue journey began in 2025 when a new resident Ms. Varada Menon took the initiative to establish a WhatsApp group, aiming to unite Emerald Isle Malayalis. While many joined the forum, active engagement remained limited in those early stages.

The arrival of Vishu 2026 marked a turning point. A dedicated team—comprising residents Varada, Aarti, Trupti, Susan, and myself, Divya along with our young-at-heart seniors, Bhaskaran uncle and Ramachandran uncle - coordinated a major effort to gather all Keralites for a day of connection, celebration, and traditional food, on the 26th April 2026.

The week leading up to the event was a whirlwind of activity, filled with rehearsals, planning, and the creation of posters and reels. On the day of the event, the team worked with nervous excitement to transform the community hall into a festive space.

The celebration was a resounding success! It was wonderful to see the community unite to enjoy an afternoon of music, dance, games and the traditional "sadya" feast. People discovered stronger bonds with their acquaintances from morning / evening walks!

This gathering is just the start. We look forward to hosting more events with the broader Emerald Isle community, I am sure everyone would love to experience an authentic Onam celebration, including a lipsmacking "onasadya" at Onam 2026.

We look forward to continuing this journey and bringing a true slice of Kerala to Emerald Isle.

- Divya Sreejith
on behalf of Emerald Isle
Malayali committee, L&T



More Than Karaoke – A Real Musical Experience



Let's Sing Studio organizes live musical programs where singers perform with musicians accompanying them. These programs are held every few months, as considerable effort goes into planning and preparation. The musicians are informed well in advance so they can attend the sessions on a particular day, while participants prepare their songs and lyrics. Unlike karaoke, the tracks are not fixed but are played live on the spot.

The owner of the studio, Manoj, offers singers an opportunity to practice at the studio before the actual performances.

The musicians play instruments such as electronic tabla, banjo, dholak, and keyboard. Before the performance begins, they first check the pitch, sound, and speaker settings. Singers also need to match their pitch with the musicians and instruments, giving them the feel of a real live singing experience.

To help warm up the vocal cords, hot tea and biscuits are served, along with snacks. Dinner is also served at the end of the program.

The studio additionally offers members the opportunity to celebrate birthdays and anniversaries. Manoj regularly encourages performers to sing during festivals such as Holi, Ram Navami, and Gudi Padwa. He also organizes theme-based programs dedicated to legendary singers like Asha Bhosle.

Members get an opportunity to sing a wide variety of songs and enjoy a rich musical experience at the studio.

To join the group, contact Manoj on: 9820293174

— Preeti Oka

When concern sounds like criticism: a better way to talk to young adults



Debika Chaudhuri

For many parents, watching a young adult make choices that seem irresponsible can trigger fear, frustration, and disappointment. Whether it is skipping college classes, withdrawing socially, or losing motivation, parents often react from a place of deep concern. Yet the words used in these moments can either build connection or create distance.

Consider this common situation: a college student repeatedly skips classes, saying they are tired, uninterested, or overwhelmed. The parent sees wasted opportunity and reacts sharply:
"You're throwing away your future. If you keep this up, you'll never amount to anything."
Although the parent's intention may be to motivate, the impact is often very different. The young adult feels judged, misunderstood, and emotionally unsafe. Instead of becoming more responsible, they may become defensive, withdrawn, or angry. The relationship suffers, and meaningful communication becomes harder.

This is where Nonviolent Communication (NVC), developed by psychologist Marshall Rosenberg, offers parents a powerful alternative.

NVC encourages us to move away from blame and criticism and toward empathy, observation, and understanding. It does not mean avoiding boundaries or pretending everything is fine. Rather, it helps parents communicate concerns in a way that preserves dignity and connection.
In the same situation, an NVC-based response may sound like this:

"I've noticed that you've been missing classes lately, and I feel worried because I care about your future. I'm wondering if something is making it difficult for you to attend, and I'd like to understand how I can support you."

Notice the difference. Instead of labels like "lazy" or "careless," the parent describes the behavior without judgment. Instead of making predictions about failure, they express their feelings honestly. Most importantly, they approach the conversation with curiosity rather than accusation.



Why does this matter?

Young adults today are navigating enormous emotional pressure. Academic stress, anxiety, uncertainty about the future, social comparison, burnout, and mental health struggles often lie beneath behaviors parents interpret as irresponsibility. While guidance and accountability are still essential, criticism can intensify shame and make communication shut down entirely.

Empathy, on the other hand, creates emotional safety. When young adults feel heard rather than attacked, they are more likely to open up about what they are experiencing. A student skipping classes may actually be struggling with depression, fear of failure, lack of confidence, or difficulty adjusting to independence.

This does not mean parents should ignore unhealthy behavior. Healthy parenting requires both compassion and boundaries. A parent can still communicate expectations while remaining respectful and supportive.

For example:
"I understand you may be struggling, and I want to support you. At the same time, attending classes is important, and we need to work together on a plan."
This approach teaches responsibility without damaging self-worth.

One of the greatest shifts parents can make is learning to pause before reacting. Harsh words spoken in moments of fear often leave lasting emotional wounds. Asking ourselves, "What is my child needing right now?" can transform the entire conversation.

Nonviolent Communication offers four simple steps parents can practice:
1. Observe without judgment.
2. Express feelings honestly.
3. Identify the underlying need or concern.
4. Make a respectful request instead of a demand.

These small changes in language can have a profound impact on family relationships.
At its heart, parenting young adults is not just about correcting behavior; it is about maintaining connection during one of the most vulnerable phases of life. When parents lead with empathy instead of criticism, they create space for honesty, growth, and resilience.

Sometimes the most powerful thing a young person can hear is not, "What is wrong with you?" but rather, "Help me understand what you're going through."

(The author, Debika Chaudhuri, runs Elzix Foundation, an Educational Consultancy for the past twelve years. She has studied across three continents and has close to three decades of experience as an Executive Educator and Career Coach. She and her team help young people make important choices at critical junctures of their lives; develop self-confidence, if they don't know what to do; help develop their skills to make the right fit; create life-changing educational experiences and help them with college admissions. She may be reached at debikac@elzixfoundation.com)

Rejected with a side of perspective



Chaarvi Athawale

There is a particular kind of evening in Powai that has a way of arriving precisely when you least want it to.

The light turns amber over the lake, unhurried, almost theatrical, as though it has been practising. The Hiranandani towers catch it and hold it a little longer than seems fair. Someone walks a dog along the waterfront with the easy manner of a person whose afternoon has gone entirely to plan. A group of friends spills out of a café, laughing at something you can't hear, which is probably for the best. The traffic on JVLR pushes forward with the blind confidence of something that has never once considered the possibility of a dead end.

And there you are, in the middle of all of it, quietly in possession of something broken.

Heartbreak Handled

The rejection that comes from love is the oldest story in the world: a friend, a partner or a family member, and it feels, every single time, as though it is happening for the first time in history. That is its particular genius, and it is a deeply annoying one. You did everything correctly, or you believed you did, which amounts to the same heartbreak, and it made no difference.

You walk the path along the lake and find, as people in pain have always found, that the world is aggressively full of other people getting on with things. Powai on an evening like this is relentlessly communal, and solitude inside it can feel like a condition rather than a choice.

But consider the lake itself. Built in 1890, engineered entirely in service of a city that needed water. And then the city changed, as cities do, and the lake's original purpose quietly became redundant. By any reasonable measure, it should have become a historical footnote with a pleasant view and an HOA dispute.

Instead, the birds arrived. Then the crocodiles, which suggests that nature has a flair for the dramatic that most of us, in our more sensible moments, can only envy. The lake became a habitat, a landmark, the thing Powai points to when it wants to explain what it is. Designed for utility, it became, without anyone quite planning it that way, something people love.

Pivot in Progress, Always

The rejection that comes from ambition is subtler, and in some ways crueller for it. There are no dramatic scenes. What you get is silence, a carefully impersonal email, or sometimes not even that.

Powai is not a gentle place in which to absorb this. It hums with ambition in a way that is almost physical, in the cafés where half the tables seem to be hosting the early stages of something, in the proximity of college campuses, in conversations where "product-market fit" gets dropped as casually as a weather update by people who are twenty-three years old and absolutely certain. The neighbourhood carries an unspoken expectation that you are on your way somewhere. That stillness is a temporary condition, best resolved quickly, preferably with funding.

And yet Powai has seen more ambitions quietly fold than it will ever advertise. The cafés hosting today's hopeful conversations have heard older versions of those same ideas, certainties that turned out to be nothing of the sort, people who wanted something badly enough that they were sure wanting would be sufficient. The city received all of it with the same equanimity. Something ended; something began. The construction dust rose and settled, as it always does, and nobody held a memorial.

Party Pooper?

The third kind of rejection is the one we discuss least, possibly because it is the hardest to explain at a dinner party without everyone looking slightly uncomfortable.

Powai is a neighbourhood of arrivals. Almost nobody is from here in any rooted sense, which means almost everyone has quietly wondered whether they have the right to call it theirs. The wondering, I think, is the wrong place to look for an answer.

The light is still amber over the lake. The traffic is still its loud, unstoppable, magnificently inconsiderate self.

And you, somewhere between the person who arrived here holding something broken and the person sitting here now, are still in it. Still moving.

A neighborhood that throws you forward does not ask whether you are ready. In this, it has a great deal in common with life in general, which has also never once checked your calendar before proceeding.

But you are still here. And that, for now, is not a small thing at all.



Sports drinks vs nimbu pani – What works?

Step into any fitness centre or sports shop in Mumbai and you will find bottles of neon colour to replenish the electrolytes, enhance stamina and help your muscles recover at a pace far quicker than nature. Price of these are between ₹80 to ₹200 per bottle. In this city, every home has lemons, salt and sugar – the ingredients in something athletes all over the subcontinent have depended on for generations. So which one does work?
The first thing you need to learn is what exercise is actually taking away. During sweating, water, salt and minerals are lost from the body and this process occurs quickly, as Mumbai is a very humid place. You also use carbs to fuel your body. This should be the minimum of any drink that is consumed during or after exercising. The food you choose to eat, then, should reflect less your gym bag contents and more your body's needs.

Scientifically designed sports drinks can do just that. They are formulated with a specific ratio of sodium, potassium and carbohydrates to ensure rapid absorption. It's that precision that really counts when it comes to competitive football, long-distance running or back-to-back training sessions for sustained high-intensity effort. The sodium makes you thirsty, the carbs provide fuel for the muscles, and it was meant to work fast.

But the twist is, it's not so simple. Not many of us are competitive athletes. However, a student who completes a half-hour of gym class or a person who takes a walk along the seafront is not in the same class as a marathon runner and thus does not require the same recovery formula. However, the marketing of sports drinks doesn't generally make this distinction. The branding is aspirational on purpose- you are supposed to feel like you are training at the level which is suitable for the product. Most people don't realize there is a significant difference in the audience for these drinks and the people that are purchasing them.

Nimbu pani, on the other hand, has never had a marketing budget and doesn't need one. This lemon juice, water, salt and sugar concoction is one that rehydrates the body quickly, replenishes some of the body's losses due to sweating and is easy to drink when it comes to stomach. It has been doing the job reliably, generation after generation, in climates much hotter than anything that a gym can produce. To be honest, even if you are working out mildly in Mumbai, where even walking to the auto can cause your body to get depleted, a well-made nimbu pani can take a lot of beating. It's also a lot more affordable.

The absence of any of these ingredients in there is also a story. It's free of artificial colours, no artificial flavouring, no ingredients that require a chemistry degree to say. This simplicity is a plus, not a minus. There's a reason for the fresh lemon's benefits, and the beverage has little impact on digestion even if your tummy isn't on the right side when you're trying to push through in the heat.

Consistency is the one thing that is limited in the honest nimbu pani. The ratios vary with each preparation, depending upon the lemon, your hands with the salt, and the quantity of sugar you add. For elite or high-competitive athletes, where accuracy is important, that variability is a problem. Commercial sports drinks do the opposite, as they are always the same.

In most cases, however, it's not really a question of which drink is the more advanced science; it's a question of which drink is better. It's a matter of "matching" to what you actually did. A hard two hours in the heat in the afternoon is a different kind of situation than a light workout followed by the shower. The latter could actually use a sports drink. The latter will do the job very well and nimbu pani, if with a little extra salt, will be okay.

The reality is most people who have paid for a sports drink are actually getting a hefty price tag for a product that their body doesn't require at this time. The lemon in your kitchen is doing the same job, mundane, silently and virtually for free for the everyday athlete in this city.

Anushka Bahorey
Grade 11,
Singapore International School
(Mumbai)



The shades - magic of a Powai monsoon



Girija Menon

There is a precise, breathless pause that settles just before the sky breaks from its grey hue. It is a moment of heavy anticipation, when will it be monsoons or when does the monsoon's story start? It's the same all over the country, and Powai is not different. Its indeed very beautiful before the onset of monsoons, during the monsoons and on days when the question is on everyone's mind "will it rain today"?

The sky over the lake doesn't merely turn grey; it bruises into a deep, velvety indigo, heavy with the weight of the coming showers. Suddenly, the distant hills of the IIT campus and the ridges beyond are swallowed whole by a low-hanging, ghostly mist. The temperature drops, sudden exhale, and the wind picks up along the promenade. It carries with it that most intoxicating of fragrances: petrichor — the scent of dry earth from the green pockets of the valley absorbing the first sharp, metallic sting of urban rain. These are the magical moments before the monsoons.

When the downpour finally arrives, it brings with it a grand visual metamorphosis, acting as a great equalizer across our landscape. Powai, by day, is a study in sharp geometric lines—a skyline of towering high-rises, gleaming glass facades, and structured stone walkways. But the monsoon is a masterful watercolour artist. It softens the hard edges of our modern architecture, turning the grand towers of Hiranandani Gardens into silent, blurred giants standing guard in the fog.

Down on the water, the transformation is even more dramatic. The lake loses its sparkling, sun-drenched blue, flattening into a dark, reflective mirror that holds the mood of the sky. Its surface becomes a frantic canvas of millions of tiny concentric circles as the heavy drops strike in unison. The water, usually static and dormant, begin a wild, swaying dance under the relentless weight of the water. Along the promenade the spray emerges – magnificent and in a way chaotic symphony of none other than nature.

As the rain settles into a steady, rhythmic drumbeat, the tempo of the streets undergoes a fascinating shift. There is a beautiful duality at play here: the modern city must maintain its momentum, yet the monsoon demands an introspective pause. Look up at the high-street cafes or through the windows of the commercial hubs, and you will see the corporate rush momentarily interrupted. Laptops are momentarily forgotten as eyes drift to the glass, caught in a collective, quiet melancholy—a sudden longing for comfort, a brief but necessary detachment from the daily hustle. But alas that is not to be because work calls and pausing to enjoy the rain or a hot brew in a café is never on the schedule.

Down on the walkways, the choreography changes entirely. The promenade, usually a theatre for high-energy joggers and fast-paced power walkers, slows down to a cautious, deliberate stride. It transforms into a moving sea of umbrellas—a shifting roof of blacks and blues punctured by sudden, defiant bursts of bright colour. Pedestrians adopt a specific monsoon waltz, their eyes cast downward, navigating the puddles that have turned into miniature mirrors reflecting the glow of the streetlights.

Yet, even in the heaviest downpour, this suburb (Powai) finds its anchors of warmth. Every neighbourhood has a sanctuary, and in Powai, it is the humble roadside cutting-chai stall. Step under the makeshift shelter of a flapping blue tarpaulin sheet during a sudden cloudburst, and you will find an accidental community. Here, a corporate executive, a college student from IIT, a security guard, and a local resident stand shoulder-to-shoulder. Stripped of their titles by the sheer, levelling force of the weather, they wait in shared silence. The damp, chilly air is cut by the sharp fragrance of fresh ginger and cardamom rising from a bubbling aluminium kettle. In that small space, the contrast between the cold fury of the storm outside and the steaming comfort of a small glass of tea becomes pure magic. My personal favourite is the lemon, masala tea with mint, piping hot served in tiny paper cups.

Ultimately, the monsoon in Powai is a profound lesson in resilience wrapped in breathtaking beauty. It brings a necessary, soulful low that forces us to look inward, reminding us of the slower, older rhythms of the earth that exist beneath our concrete and asphalt. Within hours of the heaviest storm, the suburb always emerges renewed. The dust of the year is washed away, leaving the trees looking blindingly, vibrantly green against the misty horizon. The lake swells, the traffic stalls, and the skies weep, but life here does not stop; it simply adjusts its stride. The true magic of a Powai monsoon lies in our willingness to find beauty in its damp edges, to embrace the pause, and to know that after the heaviest downpour, we always emerge washed clean, lush, and deeply alive.

Let's hope we use this formula for life in general. Washing away what not needed, emerging clean and in every way alive from within.

(Girija Menon, the author, enjoys her passion for writing. Her first love is poetry; an astute observer of the world around us, she loves writing down her thoughts in both poems and prose. LIFE THREADS is what she uses to weave this one-of-a-kind fabric that spans reams. She can be reached at – whisperingverses@gmail.com)



Energy Thieves: Recognise & fix those leakages



Palak Sardana

Energy has been the most revered resource on this planet since time immemorial. Humans have fought, strived and struggled to gain control over it.

Termed “shakti” in the Indian tradition, energy isn’t just worshipped, but sought, preserved, refined and pursued through various spiritual practices like yoga, meditation, fasting, mantra-chanting, and disciplined living.

Nations compete for it, industries are built upon it, wars are fought over it, and alliances are shaped around it. Strip away political speeches and economic jargon, and much of global conflict can be understood as a struggle for control over energy sources like oil, gas, coal, rare earth minerals, electricity grids, and renewable technologies.

The Russia-Ukraine conflict exposed Europe’s dependence on Russian gas. The Middle East has remained geopolitically volatile for decades largely because of oil reserves. China is aggressively securing lithium, cobalt, and rare earth minerals essential for batteries and renewable energy infrastructure.

The recent advisory by the Indian government urging citizens to use petrol and diesel judiciously amid global fuel uncertainty reminds us that energy is precious, finite, and foundational not just to economies, but to collective stability itself. Yet the irony is that we aren’t given any advisories nor is there enough awareness around the cultivation and management of our internal energy systems which is foundational to our existence itself.

We understand that nutrition, sleep, movement, and stress management affect our vitality. We speak of bespoke diets, workouts, and productivity hacks. But what goes largely ignored are the tiny mental and emotional leakages through which energy escapes quietly like water dripping slowly from a cracked earthen pot.

A person may eat healthy food, sleep eight hours, and still feel exhausted. Why? Because the greatest energy drains are often psychological rather than physical.
Mental and emotional energy leakages are subtle but relentless. One of the biggest among them is chronic overthinking. The human brain consumes enormous energy, and repetitive thought loops act like background apps constantly draining a phone battery. Replaying conversations, imagining worst-case scenarios, anticipating rejection, or mentally arguing with people for hours silently, exhausts the nervous system.

Emotional suppression can be an enormous drain on energy. Maintaining the façade of being “civil & fine” can be exhausting and hinder the genuine expression and processing of feelings like resentment, guilt, fear, shame, or anger. Studies by Stanford Psychologist James Gross have shown that suppressing emotions requires significant cognitive effort that increases physiological stress.



Digital overstimulation is another modern energy thief. Endless scrolling, constant notifications, rapid content consumption, and perpetual comparison overloads the brain’s attentional system. In today’s world, many people aren’t drained due to the physical labour but because of neurological overstimulation.

Lack of boundaries can leave people drained too. People pleasing, seeking external validation, feeling responsible for other people’s emotions can be more draining than a physical combat.

Lack of alignment between actions and values often develops friction within the psyche. Pursuing goals that society admires but that do not resonate with deeper self leads to cognitive dissonance, the conflict between inner beliefs and outer behavior. In the Bhagwad Gita too, Krishna encourages one to work and die within one’s own dharma (inherent nature) even if enacted imperfectly rather than pursuing or copying someone else’s (or what’s outwardly popular or rewarding). In many cases, burnout is not caused merely by working too hard but by working against oneself. These leakages aren’t in the face but are the quickest & most robust energy robbers. When mental and emotional energy is fragmented, even simple tasks feel heavy. Managing these leakages requires more than productivity hacks or motivational slogans. It requires self-awareness.

The first step is honest observation. Which conversations leave you exhausted? Which habits create restlessness? Which relationships feel nourishing and which feel performative? What activities expand you and which feel diminishing?

Emotional processing is equally important. Journaling, therapy, meditation, reflective conversations, or contemplative practices can help emotions move instead of stagnating. Emotions that are acknowledged tend to soften while the ones subdued, intensify. Reducing stimulation of all kind, whether consumption of stimulants like caffeine or pursuing digital hygiene by embracing boredom, periods of silence or solitude, all allow for nervous system rejuvenation.

Drawing healthy boundaries by saying no respectfully, not participating in every argument and not complying with every expectation can protect emotional energy.

Finally, alignment matters. When values, actions, relationships, and lifestyle begin moving in the same direction, energy leakages reduce dramatically. The world may continue battling over oil fields, minerals, fuel reserves, and electricity grids. But at the individual level, the deeper challenge is learning how to conserve one’s own life-force. External energy powers nations while internal energy powers the being itself.

In an overstimulated, emotionally challenging world, learning to conserve one’s inner Shakti is perhaps one of the most sophisticated ways of venerating it.

(Palak Sardana is a Harvard certified wellness coach, a mental health counsellor, yoga teacher & founder of wellness venture, Tranquility Unlimited. Via these articles, her endeavour is to present non-invasive & practical models of wellness grounded in ancient wisdom and modern scientific research. She runs ongoing wellness classes. For joining or booking a personalized consultation/session, write to tranquilityunlimited@gmail.com)

The cost of skipping breakfast



Nisha Singh

Breakfast - nutrition science says it's the most important meal of the day. Yet the one meal that is skipped most often. Reasons can be various. Some people do it because their mornings are rushed. Others might do it to reduce calorie consumption for weight loss. Others still complain of not being hungry enough when they wake up. And many skip it because they are either doing intermittent fasting or the current trend "OMD" or One Meal A Day. People have resorted to skipping breakfasts as a badge of honour. Amongst all these various reasons of late dinners and long commutes, breakfast has ended up being the most negotiable meal.

And in my experience this is the biggest mistake one can make towards their health. From not being helpful in weight management, fatigue, mood swings, low energy to brain fog, skipped breakfasts are often the ignored cause of these problems. While I accept that having a big breakfast might not be for everybody, it is essential to at the least have a small, nourishing portion. This is especially important for certain categories such as pregnant and breastfeeding mothers, people experiencing hormonal imbalances, diabetes, and hypertension, as well as adolescents.

Interestingly, when one regularly misses the first meal of the day, the effects do not manifest immediately. They accumulate slowly and silently over time.

So, what happens inside the body?

After dinner, the body moves to a fasting state. Usually this state can be for anywhere between ten and twelve hours. During this time, the liver provides the body with the necessary energy to continue the tasks that are essential for you to be alive, such as maintaining a stable blood sugar, blood pressure and keeping the brain functioning.

When you wake up, the hormone cortisol is naturally high, prepping you for an energetic start to the day. The usage of glucose as an energy has begun. A large part of this is utilised by the brain. To function optimally the body needs fuel and breakfast is that energy source. If you skip breakfast, your body will adapt, but not so smoothly. Sustained fasting can cause mood swings, irritability, headaches, blood sugar fluctuations, lack of focus, and even intense cravings later in the day.

Brain function is severely affected. Research shows that glucose availability influences cognitive performance, memory, and attention. Studies also suggest that children and adolescents who eat breakfast tend to perform better in concentration - based tasks. Adults face similar challenges. Surviving on caffeine is a trend that never goes away. Decision - making abilities, concentration, patience, and tolerance levels are all affected when one is on an empty stomach supported only by caffeine. The brain is extremely sensitive to blood sugar fluctuations as well as stress hormones.



A simple, warm, home - cooked, and nourishing breakfast that includes a dash of protein is sufficient. Poha with a small fistful of boiled peanuts, eggs with a multigrain toast in ghee, and chillas made with besan or moong dal and vegetables are all good options.

The next misconception is that skipping breakfast will help reduce calorie intake and aid in weight loss. However, the opposite is true. An absent breakfast signals to the body that food availability is scarce. Therefore the body stores more calories. Studies have also shown that prolonged fasting can increase ghrelin, the hunger hormone. This can cause intense cravings which are often satiated only with foods that provide instant energy to the body. Foods that are often loaded with sugar, high in refined carbohydrates, and high in fat. At that point, quick, and easy- to-grab snacks like chips, cookies, instant noodles, sugary drinks etc. make an entry.

A commonly known fact is that Indians are highly deficient in protein. Skipping breakfast further widens the gap that needs to be covered to compensate for the daily protein intake. Adequate protein is needed to maintain and build muscles, stabilise hormones, improve immunity, and promote healthy skin, hair, metabolism, and much more. It is also important to remember that large portions of protein in a single meal are not absorbed by the body. Protein intake needs to be spread through the day in various meals for maximum absorption in the body. Women are a particularly vulnerable group, especially anyone above the age of 35, since muscle loss is faster. Include a small portion of protein in every meal to meet the protein quota of the day. Sprouts, eggs, boiled peanuts, paneer, Greek yogurt, milk and milk products, chillas, chicken, and fish are all good options.

Lifestyle matters in cases of weight management. Intermittent fasting, one meal a day etc. may work for people who have a more balanced lifestyle in terms of sleep, exercise and food choices. Whereas for someone who works late hours, has higher stress levels, irregular eating patterns and unfulfilled sleep debt will endure a more negative impact of a skipped breakfast. Unfortunately modern lifestyles ensure that there is always a low grade stress present. Some studies show that irregular meal timing can affect insulin sensitivity and circadian rhythm. Circadian rhythm is the body's internal clock that regulates sleep, hormones, metabolism, and entire functioning.

The key is to ensure consistency. The body likes routine. It likes rhythm. Try to stick to simple habits that you can do regularly and slowly add to it. Wake up ten minutes earlier, do some pranayam, have some sunlight exposure, move a little more, eat more mindfully and clean, try to get sleep at regular timing daily. Small and simple habits go a long way in maintaining health and well being. Do not opt for complicated routines or complicated meals. Ensure that your breakfast is warm and nourishing, that there is 15 - 20 grams of protein in every meal, avoid sugar rich food items in breakfast, drink enough water since you wake up ensuring good hydration, move after meals and try to avoid both, either stress eating or stress fasting.

As always, try to maintain a BALANCE. Incorporate sustainable habits, so that your body doesn't feel threatened. Instead it should feel nourished.

(The writer is a gold medalist in Food & Nutrition with more than 12 years experience. She manages various ailments through lifestyle and dietary modifications and specializes in weight loss & management. She practices at 102, Crystal Center, Raheja Vihar, Powai or Smile Craft, 23, Annapurna Industrial estate, Opp. CCD, Ghatkopar East. For appointments: 022 2857 6537 Email: singhnisha@gmail.com)

Acharnama: Tales of mangoes, spice and sunlight



Sherry Bhatnagar

In the previous article, we ended with a promise — that we would return with the time-honoured traditional recipes of mango pickles carried across generations, borders, and continents like treasured family heirlooms. This is that journey. And like all dangerous journeys, it begins with a knife slicing into raw mangoes. The first crack of the seed. The sharp green aroma flooding the kitchen. The sting of salt on fingertips. The sudden appearance of giant ceramic jars pulled out from dark storerooms. Every summer, somewhere in the world, mangoes are being cut, salted, dried, fermented, buried in spice, or left under ruthless sunlight until they surrender into pickle.

I discovered this not through cookbooks, but through conversations. "Never trust a pickle made in haste," my Punjabi friend Raj warned me over a crackling phone call from Amritsar. In her home, mango pickling is almost a sacred military operation. Raw mangoes are washed, wiped dry, and spread under fans for hours. Even a single drop of water is treated like sabotage. "Our achar survives an entire year," she declared proudly. "Moisture is the enemy." Her Punjabi Aam ka achar is bold and unapologetic — thick mango chunks drowned in mustard oil, layered with crushed mustard seeds, fennel, fenugreek, turmeric and enough red chilli to wake the dead. The jars then sit on rooftops under blazing summer sun. "The sun finishes the recipe," she whispered.

From Punjab, the trail led west to Gujarat, where mango pickle became softer, sweeter and almost playful. "We pickle mangoes the way we preserve happiness," laughed Monica from Surat. Her family makes Chhundo — grated raw mango slowly melting into sugar beneath layers of spice. Every morning, the jars are carefully turned so sunlight reaches every side evenly. "No gas stove," she insisted. "Only the sun must cook it." The result is sticky, glowing, sweet-hot magic that clings to the spoon like amber.

Then came Andhra Pradesh, and perhaps I should have prepared myself. "Our Avakaya is not pickle," Neha from Vizag announced dramatically. "It is an emotion. A dangerous one." Andhra's legendary Avakaya looks volcanic — giant mango pieces coated in fiery Guntur chilli powder, mustard powder, garlic and sesame oil. Families prepare it in enormous batches, enough to feed entire households for months. "The smell alone can make neighbours jealous," Neha laughed.

Further south in Kerala, the mood changed completely. Priya introduced me to Kadumanga Achar, where tiny baby mangoes are pickled whole with mustard seeds, curry leaves, green chillies, vinegar and coconut oil. "It tastes like rain," she said softly. In Bengal, however, mango pickle transformed into poetry itself. "Bengalis don't make pickles," Mishti from Kolkata corrected me. "We romance them."

Their Aamer Achar swings between sweet and spicy with dramatic confidence. Some versions simmer with jaggery, dates, raisins and panch phoron until the kitchen smells almost sinful. Others rely on mustard oil and nigella seeds for a sharper edge. "No recipe is final," she smiled. "Every grandmother edits it."



Then the journey escaped India entirely. In Thailand, my friend Mali introduced me to fiercely sour mango pickles sold in floating markets. Thin slices of green mango are soaked in brine with bird's eye chillies, palm sugar and fish sauce. "It must shock your tongue first," she laughed. Thai mango pickles are bright, sharp and addictive — less about preservation and more about explosive flavour. Malaysia brought another surprise. In Kuala Lumpur, Farida described Jeruk Mangga — crunchy mango pickles soaked in sugar, salt, vinegar and chilli. Street vendors sell them in plastic packets near train stations and busy roadsides. "You eat them while walking," he said, "and immediately crave another packet."

Even Europe, surprisingly, has fallen under the spell of mango pickling. In London, Indian families still sun-cure jars on apartment balconies whenever summer appears for a few precious days. Meanwhile, experimental chefs in parts of Germany and the Netherlands have begun fermenting raw mangoes with vinegar, mustard, dill and herbs, creating unusual hybrids between Indian achar and European pickled vegetables. "They taste confused," Anita from London joked, "but strangely addictive."

But across continents, one truth repeated itself constantly: a pickle recipe is never just a recipe. It is inheritance. Climate. Migration. Memory trapped inside a jar. Hot regions use more oil and salt. Humid climates depend on vinegar. Colder countries improvise with refrigeration. Yet everyone gave me the same warning — keep water away, respect the sun and never rush the waiting. Because mango pickle is alive. It darkens slowly, softens secretly and absorbs spice the way memory absorbs time. Perhaps that is why opening an old jar of mango pickle feels almost supernatural — as if trapped summers, vanished kitchens and forgotten voices suddenly escape back into the room. Next time, we travel deeper into the sweeter, darker world of ripe mango pickles, where jaggery bubbles, spices caramelise and mangoes transform into something dangerously close to dessert. The addictive journey continues.

(Sherry Bhatnagar is a passionate food storyteller with deep roots in Indian regional cuisine, the author writes where memory, migration, and the kitchen intersect. Having lived across cultures yet firmly anchored in Indian flavours, her work explores food not just as nourishment, but as identity, tradition, and lived experience—told with honesty, restraint, and quiet depth.)

June 2026



Richa Pathak

June is not a sleepy month. It carries movement, mood swings, sudden conversations, unexpected clarity, and a strange urge to either fix everything or escape from everything. The trick? Do neither. This month rewards emotional intelligence far more than impulse. Some signs will feel recharged, some emotionally stretched—but every sign gets a lesson in boundaries.

Aries (Mar 21 – Apr 19)
June may make you feel like everything needs your immediate attention—but it doesn't. You're carrying strong action energy, but reacting to every message, demand, or opinion will drain you. A professional opening may look exciting, but read the fine print. In love, being softer will get you much further than being right. **Lucky Color:** Burnt Orange **Lucky Day:** Tuesday **Remedy:** Keep a copper coin in your wallet to calm impulsive Mars energy.

Taurus (Apr 20 – May 20)
You've been craving stability, but June reminds you that comfort and growth don't always sit in the same room. Financially, this is a "be smarter, not stricter" month. Emotionally, someone may test your patience—but your silence can be more powerful than your reaction. Avoid stubborn decisions made just to prove a point. **Lucky Color:** Sage Green **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Light a rose-scented diya on Friday evenings.

Gemini (May 21 – Jun 20)
Your birthday season keeps you socially alive, mentally active, and dangerously overbooked. June's biggest lesson? Not every invitation deserves a yes. A conversation could unexpectedly shift your career path or personal thinking. Be careful with sleep—your mind won't switch off easily this month. **Lucky Color:** Soft Yellow **Lucky Day:** Wednesday **Remedy:** Keep a glass bowl with fresh mint leaves near your desk.

Cancer (Jun 21 – Jul 22)
This month feels like emotional housekeeping. Old thoughts, unfinished conversations, family energy—you'll feel everything more deeply than usual. Don't mistake sensitivity for weakness. Financially, avoid spending to comfort your emotions. Someone close may need your compassion, but not at the cost of your own peace. **Lucky Color:** Moon White **Lucky Day:** Monday **Remedy:** Keep moon-charged water near your bedside overnight.

Leo (Jul 23 – Aug 22)
June brings attention—but not all attention is useful. Some people admire you, others simply watch you. Know the difference. Professionally, visibility increases, but consistency matters more than charisma now. In relationships, drop the dramatic testing games. Emotional honesty will feel far more attractive. **Lucky Color:** Sun Gold **Lucky Day:** Sunday **Remedy:** Wear a touch of gold or warm yellow on important days.

Virgo (Aug 23 – Sep 22)
Your brain is already planning three months ahead, but June asks you to come back to the present. Not everything needs fixing immediately. A work situation may improve once you stop micromanaging it. Digestive health and stress are connected this month—your body will reflect your thoughts. **Lucky Color:** Herbal Green **Lucky Day:** Thursday **Remedy:** Start your mornings with warm water and a quiet 5-minute reset.



Libra (Sep 23 – Oct 22)
This month may bring a strange emotional tug between what feels easy and what feels right. Relationships require clearer communication—especially where assumptions have replaced conversations. Professionally, your diplomacy becomes your strength. Stop romanticising indecision. **Lucky Color:** Dusty Rose **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Keep fresh pink flowers in your bedroom or workspace.

Scorpio (Oct 23 – Nov 21)
June is intense—but in a productive way. Hidden emotions, hidden truths, even hidden opportunities may surface. You'll instinctively know when something feels off, so trust that. Financial caution is necessary around shared money or emotional spending. Avoid shutting people out completely. **Lucky Color:** Dark Plum **Lucky Day:** Tuesday **Remedy:** Burn a clove in the evening to clear emotional heaviness.

Sagittarius (Nov 22 – Dec 21)
Your restlessness is back, and suddenly everything feels too slow. Travel, movement, fresh ideas—you want expansion. But June teaches commitment. Excitement is easy. Follow-through is where your blessing lies. Relationships may surprise you if you stop treating emotional conversations like chores. **Lucky Color:** Cobalt Blue **Lucky Day:** Thursday **Remedy:** Keep a yellow journal for ideas worth pursuing.

Capricorn (Dec 22 – Jan 19)
June feels practical, but emotionally heavier than you admit. Work demands structure, but your personal life may quietly ask for softness. Delegation becomes important—doing everything alone isn't strength anymore. Financially steady, emotionally tired. **Lucky Color:** Stone Grey **Lucky Day:** Saturday **Remedy:** Keep a black stone or grounding crystal near your workspace.

Aquarius (Jan 20 – Feb 18)
June wakes up your creativity, but your attention span may be all over the place. Great month for ideas, not great month for chaos. Romantic energy feels unexpectedly active. Someone unusual may catch your interest. Protect your sleep—your mind will be unusually electric. **Lucky Color:** Electric Teal **Lucky Day:** Wednesday **Remedy:** Keep a bowl of water with flower petals in the north direction.

Pisces (Feb 19 – Mar 20)
June may feel emotionally cinematic—you'll imagine conversations that haven't happened yet. Ground yourself. Home, family, emotional healing, and boundaries all become major themes. Financially, avoid making generosity your weakness. Creativity feels strong if emotions are channelled well. **Lucky Color:** Sea Aqua **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Add a few drops of rose water to your pillow before sleep.

(Astrologer Richa Pathak masters the art of Astrology, Vastu & Numerology. In-person consultation with prior appointment can be done at 207, Lantana, Nahar Amrit Shakti, Chandivali, Powai. She also gives Virtual Consultation & can be reached @ 8 4 5 2 9 2 0 6 4 0 & www.jyotishdham.com)